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Shoe sanitizing method

Abstract

A shoe sanitizing method includes the pouring of a sanitizing agent on an absorbent pad positioned in a housing to saturate the absorbent pad with the sanitizing agent. A person steps on the absorbent pad with a shoe such that a bottom of the shoe is cleaned with the sanitizing agent. The shoe is removed from the absorbent pad and the absorbent pad is removed from the housing for cleaning or replacement when the absorbent pad is soiled.

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WO2019090335	12/2018	WO	N/A

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) Not Applicable

STATEMENT REGARDING FEDERALLY SPONSORED RESEARCH OR DEVELOPMENT

(2) Not Applicable

THE NAMES OF THE PARTIES TO A JOINT RESEARCH AGREEMENT

(3) Not Applicable

INCORPORATION-BY-REFERENCE OF MATERIAL SUBMITTED ON A COMPACT DISC OR AS A TEXT FILE VIA THE OFFICE ELECTRONIC FILING SYSTEM

(4) Not Applicable

STATEMENT REGARDING PRIOR DISCLOSURES BY THE INVENTOR OR JOINT INVENTOR

(5) Not Applicable

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(1) Field of the Invention

(6) The disclosure relates to shoe sanitizing device and more particularly pertains to a new shoe sanitizing device for allowing a person to sanitize a bottom of their shoe as they are wearing it. Thus, the sanitizing device disclosed herein may also be used as a door mat.

(2) Description of Related Art Including Information Disclosed Under 37 CFR 1.97 and 1.98

(7) The prior art relates to shoe sanitizing devices that wipe down a shoe to disinfect the shoe.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(8) An embodiment of the disclosure meets the needs presented above by generally including the pouring of a sanitizing agent on an absorbent pad positioned in a housing to saturate the absorbent pad with the sanitizing agent. A person steps on the absorbent pad with a shoe such that a bottom of the shoe is cleaned with the sanitizing agent. The shoe is removed from the absorbent pad and the

absorbent pad is removed from the housing for cleaning or replacement when the absorbent pad is soiled.

(9) There has thus been outlined, rather broadly, the more important features of the disclosure in order that the detailed description thereof that follows may be better understood, and in order that the present contribution to the art may be better appreciated. There are additional features of the disclosure that will be described hereinafter and which will form the subject matter of the claims appended hereto.

(10) The objects of the disclosure, along with the various features of novelty which characterize the disclosure, are pointed out with particularity in the claims annexed to and forming a part of this disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWING(S)

(1) The disclosure will be better understood and objects other than those set forth above will become apparent when consideration is given to the following detailed description thereof. Such description makes reference to the annexed drawings wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 is a top view of a shoe sanitizing method according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a top view of a second embodiment of the disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 is a top view of a third embodiment of the disclosure.

(5) FIG. 4 is a top view of a fourth embodiment of the disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 is a top isometric in-use view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

(7) FIG. 6 is a top isometric in-use view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

(8) FIG. 7 is a top isometric in-use view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

(9) FIG. 8 is a top isometric view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(10) With reference now to the drawings, and in particular to FIGS. 1 through 8 thereof, a new shoe sanitizing device embodying the principles and concepts of an embodiment of the disclosure and generally designated by the reference numeral **10** will be described.

(11) As best illustrated in FIGS. 1 through 8, the shoe sanitizing method **10** generally comprises pouring a sanitizing agent **12** on an absorbent pad **14** positioned in a housing **16** to saturate the absorbent pad **14** with the sanitizing agent **12**. The sanitizing agent **12** may comprise any conventional composition utilized for cleaning a shoe **18** in such a manner that bacteria on a bottom side **20** of the shoe **18** is killed. However, a sanitizing agent **12** may be selected which does not damage flooring should the shoe **18** be worn after being sanitized. Additionally, the absorbent pad **14** may include a frictionally enhanced service to remove any debris or residue from the shoe **18**.

(12) The absorbent pad **14** has a height greater than 0.5 inches and less than 4.0 inches and will typically have an upper surface **22** with an area that is greater than 1.0 ft.². The absorbent pad **14** will typically be comprised of a foam material having high absorptive properties. This may be preferred over a paper-based product which cannot be washed. However, natural materials which can be woven such as cotton or hemp may be used instead of a synthetic foam material.

(13) The housing **16** is comprised of a water impermeable material which may include plastics, metals, elastomers and the like. The housing **16** includes a bottom wall **24** that has a perimeter edge **26**. A perimeter wall **28** is coextensive with and extends upwardly from the perimeter edge **26**. A height that the perimeter wall **28** extends upwardly from an upper side **30** of the bottom wall **24** is within 0.5 inches of the height of the absorbent pad **14**. As can be seen in the Figures, the housing **16** and absorbent pad **12** may be provided in a variety of shapes and sizes as is desired by a user of the method **10**.

(14) Once the absorbent pad **14** has been saturated with the sanitizing agent **12**, a person will step

upon the absorbent pad **14** with their shoe **20** such that a bottom **20** of the shoe **18** is cleaned with the sanitizing agent **12** as the sanitizing agent **12** is transferred from the absorbent pad **14** to the shoe **20**. The shoe **20** is then removed from the absorbent pad **14** and worn in a conventional manner. After being used multiple times, the absorbent pad **14** may become soiled. At this time, the absorbent pad **14** may be removed from the housing **16** for cleaning or replacement.

(15) Other methods contemplated may include the sanitizing other objects which are positioned on the absorbent pad **14**. This may include, for example, bare feet, luggage wheels, stroller wheels, and the like. Additionally, when pet safe sanitizing agent **12** is utilized, the method may include sanitizing pet feet by have pets walk onto the absorbent pad **14**.

(16) With respect to the above description then, it is to be realized that the optimum dimensional relationships for the parts of an embodiment enabled by the disclosure, to include variations in size, materials, shape, form, function and manner of operation, assembly and use, are deemed readily apparent and obvious to one skilled in the art, and all equivalent relationships to those illustrated in the drawings and described in the specification are intended to be encompassed by an embodiment of the disclosure.

(17) Therefore, the foregoing is considered as illustrative only of the principles of the disclosure. Further, since numerous modifications and changes will readily occur to those skilled in the art, it is not desired to limit the disclosure to the exact construction and operation shown and described, and accordingly, all suitable modifications and equivalents may be resorted to, falling within the scope of the disclosure. In this patent document, the word “comprising” is used in its non-limiting sense to mean that items following the word are included, but items not specifically mentioned are not excluded. A reference to an element by the indefinite article “a” does not exclude the possibility that more than one of the element is present, unless the context clearly requires that there be only one of the elements.

Claims

1. A method of sanitizing footwear before walking on a floor surface, the method including the steps of: pouring a sanitizing agent on an absorbent pad positioned in a housing to saturate the absorbent pad with the sanitizing agent, the housing including a bottom wall having a perimeter edge, a perimeter wall being coextensive with and extending upwardly from the perimeter edge, a height of the perimeter wall extending upwardly from an upper side of the bottom wall such that an upper surface of the absorbent pad is coplanar with an upper edge of the perimeter wall; stepping on the absorbent pad with a shoe such that a bottom of the shoe is cleaned with the sanitizing agent; removing the shoe from the absorbent pad; and removing the absorbent pad from the housing when the absorbent pad is soiled.
2. The method of sanitizing footwear before walking on a floor surface according to claim 1, wherein the step of pouring the sanitizing agent on the absorbent pad further includes the absorbent pad having a height greater than 0.5 inches and less than 4.0 inches.
3. The method of sanitizing footwear before walking on a floor surface according to claim 1, wherein the step of pouring the sanitizing agent on the absorbent pad further includes the upper surface of the absorbent pad having an area being greater than 1.0 ft.sup.2.
4. The method of sanitizing footwear before walking on a floor surface according to claim 1, wherein the step of pouring the sanitizing agent on the absorbent pad further includes the absorbent pad being comprised of a foam material.
5. The method of sanitizing footwear before walking on a floor surface according to claim 1, wherein the step of pouring the sanitizing agent on the absorbent pad further includes the housing being comprised of a water impermeable material.
6. A method of sanitizing footwear before walking on a floor surface, the method including the steps of: pouring a sanitizing agent on an absorbent pad positioned in a housing to saturate the

absorbent pad with the sanitizing agent, the absorbent pad having a height greater than 0.5 inches and less than 4.0 inches, the absorbent pad having an upper surface having an area being greater than 1.0 ft.², the absorbent pad being comprised of a foam material, the housing being comprised of a water impermeable material, the housing including a bottom wall having a perimeter edge, a perimeter wall being coextensive with and extending upwardly from the perimeter edge, a height of the perimeter wall extending upwardly from an upper side of the bottom wall such that the upper surface of the absorbent pad is coplanar with an upper edge of the perimeter wall; stepping on the absorbent pad with a shoe such that a bottom of the shoe is cleaned with the sanitizing agent; removing the shoe from the absorbent pad; and removing the absorbent pad from the housing when the absorbent pad is soiled.
